

Content Strategy Plan for the UNT Technical Communications Website

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Executive Summary

This report summarizes the overall findings and solutions that were reached through a semester-long process of analyzing various parts of UNT's Technical Communication's Department Website.

After engaging in several different types of content evaluations, including stakeholder interviews, a Google Analytics review, and a complete website content audit, the following conclusions were reached.

First, through these methods it became clear that the faculty and staff pages, as well as the alumni page, need updating. The profile information across the faculty and staff pages is inconsistent, some of the profile pictures are blurry, and additional details (such as when their office hours are) would be extremely helpful to students. The alumni page also appears antiquated, with fuzzy photos and old testimonies, the most recent being from 2016.

To resolve this problem, the content on the faculty and staff pages, as well as the alumni page, need to be updated as soon as possible. Fresh photos of the faculty and staff—complete with uniform green backgrounds—would completely revamp the look of the pages, while implementing standardized profile questions would create uniformity in the information presented. The alumni page could easily be updated by connecting with recent Tech Comm graduates, asking them a few prewritten questions, and requesting a headshot.

Secondly, it became obvious through this process that the website users noticed a lack of information pertaining to the Tech Comm socials, as well as the near-complete lack of content regarding internship opportunities. Although the Technical Communication Department has several active social media accounts, a surprising number of students expressed that they either had no idea these socials existed or had found out about them through a classmate or friend—not through the website. This emphasizes the lack of attention the website brings to the Tech Comm social media, an unfortunate occurrence since the socials are where the department announces most of its upcoming events and opportunities. Students also noticed the lack of information regarding internships, even though internships are a key part of an undergrad's degree plan (especially the BA in Content Strategy). Currently, the only way to obtain information on the internship is to click an in-text link hidden in the BA degree class list.

To resolve these issues, it would be a relatively easy fix to make links to the socials more apparent on the webpages. This could be done by moving them to the top of the page or incorporating more flashy icons that contain a call to action for students to “connect with

us” on social media. Likewise, the internship information problem could be easily resolved by creating a webpage like the webpage already devoted to scholarships [Figure 2], with materials specifically designed to help students learn about and obtain internships.

Introduction

The purpose of this report is to present a comprehensive list of recommendations for improving the content currently found on UNT's Technical Communications Department website (Tech Comm for short), while also providing a strategic plan for maintaining and creating content for the site in the future.

The report first reviews the process undergone to create such recommendations. It analyzes the various methods used to obtain a view of the website's target audience, and outlines how these methods provided the evidence used to create the four content goals that this report discusses.

The report then describes the target audience that the report is based on and gives adequate reasons for how that conclusion was made. It also describes the persona that was created based on the chosen target audience and demonstrates how it can be used to make future decisions regarding the content that should be housed on the website.

Finally, this report provides a detailed look at two recommended updates to the Tech Comm website to improve its usability for its target audience, complete with examples and wireframes. The report also provides a sample editorial calendar which could be followed to successfully implement these updates onto the website.

Content Goals

Engage Students with Clear and Updated Information

Students browsing through the content on techcomm.unt.edu should be able to trust the information they see. It should be updated, clearly written but engaging, and be accompanied by an appropriate picture or graphic.

Supply Students with Details on Faculty and Staff

Students using the Tech Comm pages should be able to find updated information regarding each of the professors and staff members in order to assist them in finding office hours, room locations, emails, and current class offerings.

Assist Students with Scholarships and Internships

Students should easily be able to find help with their scholarship and internship aspirations on the Tech Comm website.

Provide Information Leading to TECM Socials

Students, many of whom spend much of their time on social media, should easily be able to find and access the Tech Comm social media accounts to aid them with job searches, alumni advice, and information about current Tech Comm events.

Audience

Target Audience

The target audience for the website is mainly current college-aged students (18-24) who wish to obtain a writing, professional, or technical degree. These students are already involved in some capacity with the Technical Communications Department and desire up-to-date information regarding networking opportunities, how to apply for scholarships, help with internships, information about professors, and ongoing department events.

These students are busy, tech savvy individuals, many of whom go to work part time on top of their classes. Because they don't have much time, these students need the Tech Comm website to provide them with the information they need—when they need it. Overall the persona, named Joana, would like to see more resources for students aimed at helping them connect to the Tech Comm department and UNT alumni, finding internships, and ultimately getting a good job.

Audience Persona

To give a face and name to the website's target audience, we created an audience persona as seen in [Figure 1].

Figure 1: Persona Joanah Kent

Joanah Kent

"As a current college student, I want to be prepared as much as possible for my future career."



Age : 22

BA in Content Strategy

Denton, TX

About:
Joanah is a 22-year-old college student. She lives in Denton, Texas, goes to school full time, and works part time as well. She enjoys hanging out with friends, going to social events, and networking for her future career. Joanah has spent a lot of time on the Tech Comm website: browsing for classes, booking appointments with advisors, and looking for helpful information regarding internships, scholarships, and professors.

Frustrations:
Joanah noticed that information regarding internships was nonexistent on the Tech Comm website. She also noticed that the Tech Comm's social media was difficult to find. She knew about the Tech Comm LinkedIn only because a friend told her; before then she had no idea it existed.

Goals:

- Get scholarships to help pay for college
- Get connected with Tech Comm alumni
- Get an internship before graduating

Review of Current Content

Methods

To fully understand the status of the current website's content, a complete website overview was performed, incorporating several different types of content evaluations. The procedures of each content evaluation are described in some detail below:

Stakeholder Interviews: Interviewed current Tech Comm students who use the departments website for a variety of activities, and asked them their opinions regarding its content, current usability, and relevance. This process provided the backbone for the creation of the websites target audience and persona.

Review of Website Analytics: Conducted a review of the website's analytical data using the Google Analytics platform and identified some trends—including where primary users originated, what language they used, and how they got to the website—that were crucial in creating the website's target audience and persona.

Creation of Personas: Created personas using the information identified in the stakeholder interview and website analytics to give a face, voice, and name to the website's main user body. As part of this process, the persona's pain points, desires, website uses, and their ideas for how it should be improved were identified.

Analyzation of Competitors' Websites: Analyzed websites from competing colleges with similar Tech Comm programs to see what could be improved on our own website. Then summarized biggest findings for future use.

Complete Website Content Audit: Completed a Content Audit for the Tech Comm website, which defined the types of content found on the website (including Text/html, JPG and PNG Images, and Application/PDF's), analyzed how well they were being utilized, whether the content was relevant to the websites core audience, how it was optimizing SEO, and whether it could be improved upon in some way.

Findings

The results of the above analyses are discussed in some detail below.

Stakeholder Interviews:

In the stakeholder interviews of current Tech Comm department website users, the biggest points that they identified were that information on internships was unavailable, that the alumni and faculty and staff pages were outdated, that there was little to no information on career advice, and that information regarding the Tech Comm social pages was difficult to locate.

The interviewees also noted that they used the website most often for finding classes, looking at professors, scheduling advising appointments, and researching the degree plan and career opportunities.

Of the suggested improvements that they made, the most prevalent were: updating the alumni connections page, making information regarding the Tech Comm socials more clearly visible, and adding more information on career fields, internships, job outlooks, and networking opportunities.

Review of Website Analytics

The most applicable of the findings noted in the review of the Tech Comm website's analytics were that most of the primary users (from March 1, 2025 to April 30, 2025)

originated in Texas—especially in the DFW area—that most of the primary users (54.54%) used English as their preferred language, and that Google was the platform that a majority of users used to enter the website.

Creation of Personas

The creation of a persona to represent the target audience of the website helped to identify key components that most audience members care about and helped to articulate them in a meaningful way.

Joanah, the persona created, represents current Tech Comm students and speaks on the lack of resources connecting students to the Tech Comm department's social media accounts, the complete lack of information on internships, and the outdated alumni pages.

Analyzation of Competitors' Websites

During the analyzation of competitors' websites, evaluations were made on which types of content would be helpful to implement on the Tech Comm website. The most important of these observations were that sidebars with important quick-facts (such as dates, stats, links, etc.) could be added on several of the webpages, that providing more information on job outlooks could be useful, that the faculty and staff pages could provide more information (office hours and which classes they are currently teaching, for example), and finally that there should be additional pages dedicated to study-abroad programs, tutoring, and student services.

Complete Website Content Audit

Upon the completion of the content audit, it was noted that the types of content used included Text/html, various types of images, and PDF's. The utilization of these different content types varied depending on what the content was, where the content was housed, and whether it looked recently updated or not. Their relevancy to the Tech Comm department also varied, but most scored high. In terms of SEO optimization, it was generally thought that the content was well optimized, with well thought out key terms, and descriptions in their coding.

The results of the content audit can be condensed into four observations. First, the profile pictures and pages for the staff and faculty pages scored universally low, demonstrating their urgent need for an update. The alumni page also scored low, since the latest testimony is from 2016, and all the pictures look outdated. Most of the stock photos used on the website also scored low, as many thought they looked too general and didn't help make the website stand apart enough. Finally, it was discovered that the website used a PDF, embedded as an in-text link hidden in the BA degree class list, instead of a separate

webpage devoted to the department's internship program, a decision many agreed makes little sense and should be revised immediately.

Recommendations

Engage Students with Clear and Updated Information

1. Clear Information

Information presented on the Tech Comm website should be styled in a clear, concise, and direct manner, without superfluous flair. The pictures and graphics used on the website should also reflect the content more accurately and show real Tech Comm students accomplishing relevant tasks.

Recommendation: The website should follow a strict style guide to ensure that each page conforms to the Tech Comm department standards, and all pictures and graphics should be updated to reflect the current student body.

2. Updated Information

The webpages should be regularly reviewed and updated according to how evergreen its content is [Figure 1]. If content across the entire website was reviewed using an editorial calendar [Figure 4], the website would fulfill one of its chief objectives by always providing students with up-to-date information, whether it be in the faculty and staff pages, alumni testimonies, class descriptions, internship opportunities, or scholarship application pages.

Recommendation: Update content across the website immediately (including the alumni testimonies and faculty and staff pages) and then review them according to an editorial calendar.

Supply Students with Details on Faculty and Staff

Students should have access to updated details on both the faculty and staff pages, in order to help them access their professor's office hours, office location, email address, current courses, biography, and other student-relevant information.

Recommendation: Immediately update the faculty and staff pages on the Tech Comm website, and hereafter update them regularly every four to six months. Make sure the types of information provided are consistent across all the profiles (Ex. If one professor provides their interests outside of the classroom, all profiles should contain that information to promote uniformity across the website).

Assist Students with Scholarships and Internships

1. Scholarships

The webpage for the scholarships should be edited to include tips on how to write scholarship essays, what to include on the scholarship application, and a timeline for scholarship due dates.

Recommendation: The scholarship page should have a minor glow-up to include tips on scholarship essay writing, examples of good scholarship applications, and a visual timeline so students can “see” when a particular scholarship application is due. This page, once updated, only needs to be reviewed once a year to update the scholarship deadlines.

2. Internships

A page dedicated to helping students learn about and find internships should be created. This would benefit both BA Content Strategy students who have the option to hold an internship as part of their degree plan, as well as any BS Technical Communications students who desire the extra experience.

Recommendation: Discard the current Internship PDF and create a webpage that contains all of its information with the addition of:

- Common internship titles that would benefit Tech Comm students
- A how-to for internship applications
- Connection to the Tech Comm LinkedIn, where current internship opportunities are regularly listed by Dr. Kim

Provide Information Leading to Tech Comm Socials

Many Tech Comm students have little to no idea that the Tech Comm department is active on social media, especially on LinkedIn. Providing a clear “connect with us” button, or visible social media icons at the top of the website pages—instead of at the bottom—would help with visibility to students.

Recommendation: Move social media icons from the bottom of the website pages to the top, and perhaps create a graphic that tells students that the department has socials.

Content Models

Content Model 1: Internship Web Page

Description of Content Types

Title:

Title of the internship webpage.

Description:

A brief description of what internships are, followed by common internship positions Tech Comm students would benefit from, and finally links to several “How-To” guides.

Images:

Images relating to students filling out internship applications and accomplishing intern activities. There will also be several logos (LinkedIn, Tech Comm department logo).

Call to Action:

A call for students to go visit the Tech Comm department’s LinkedIn page, where real current internship applications are regularly posted by faculty members.

Sample Content Types

Title:

Internships

Description:

An internship is a temporary part-time or full-time position at a company. Students engaged in internships go through on-the-job training, receive mentoring, and gain real life experience in a field that interests them. Internships are a great way to test the water in a career before fully committing to it.

Several common internship titles that Tech Comm students would benefit from:

- Technical Writer
- Technical Communicator
- Proposal Writer
- Content Consultant
- UX Design
- Technical Author
- Grant Writer
- Content Developer
- Copywriting
- Digital Copywriting

Links to: “How to Search for Internships,” “How to Apply for An Internship”

Visuals:

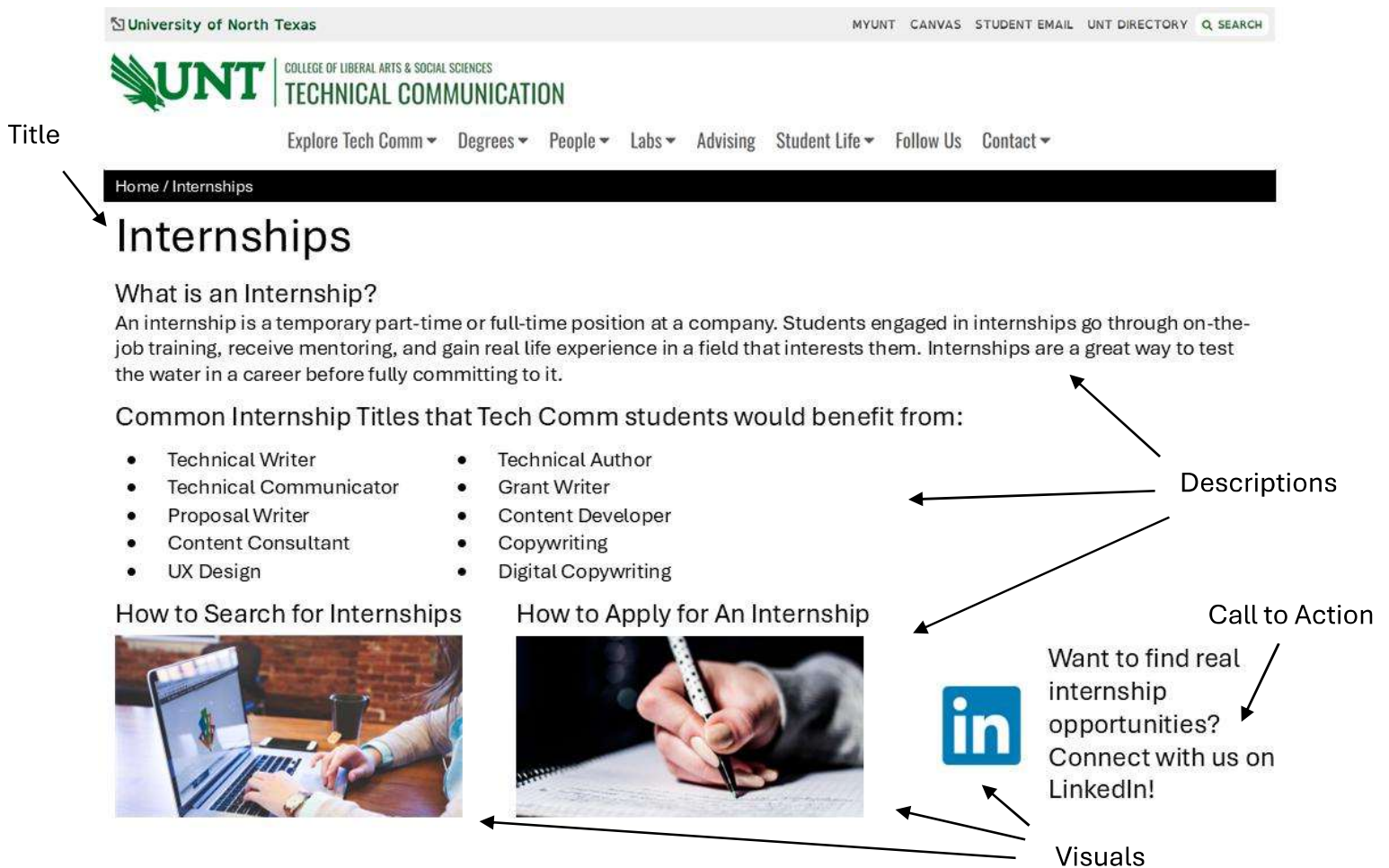


Call to Action:

Want to find real internship opportunities? Connect with us on LinkedIn!

Wireframe

Figure 2: Wireframe 1



Content Model 2: An Updated Faculty Members Page

Description of Content Types

Title:

The name of the faculty member, with a sub-heading that tells their position at the college (Assistant Professor, Professor, etc.).

Description:

Information on the faculty member, including their: education, office location, office hours, current classes, email address, teaching interests, research interests, and membership or awards (if applicable).

Image:

A clear image of the faculty member with a plain green background.

Call to Action:

Email icon button at the bottom of the page.

Sample Content Types

***Disclaimer** To not fabricate false information about a current staff or faculty member in the UNT Tech Comm department, I have opted to use a historical figure instead. Facts may not be accurate.*

Title:

George Washington

Assistant Professor

Description:

Education: Self-taught

About: George Washington, former commander-in-chief of the U.S. Continental Army and first U.S President, specializes in leadership and nation development. In his free time, he enjoys hunting, horseback riding, and playing with his step-kids.

Interests: George Washington's academic interests include civic virtue, federalism, and early American diplomacy.

Office: Auditorium Building 404A

Office Hours: M/W 1-3pm (In-Person) T/Th 2-3pm (Online)

Teaching: TECM 5170: Grants and Proposals

Email Address: George.washington@unt.edu

Image:



Call to Action:



Wireframe

Figure 3: Wireframe 2

University of North Texas

MYUNT CANVAS STUDENT EMAIL UNT DIRECTORY SEARCH

UNT COLLEGE OF LIBERAL ARTS & SOCIAL SCIENCES TECHNICAL COMMUNICATION

Explore Tech Comm ▾ Degrees ▾ People ▾ Labs ▾ Advising Student Life ▾ Follow Us Contact ▾

Image → 

Title → **George Washington**
Assistant Professor

Office Hours: M/W 1-3pm (In-Person) T/Th 2-3pm (Online)
Office Location: Auditorium Building 404A
Email: George.washington@unt.edu
Teaching: TECM 5170: Grants and Proposals

Call to Action → 
Email me for more information

Descriptions →

Education: Self-taught

About: George Washington, former commander-in-chief of the U.S. Continental Army and first U.S President, specializes in leadership and nation development. In his free time, he enjoys hunting, horseback riding, and playing with his step-kids.

Interests: George Washington's academic interests include civic virtue, federalism, and early American diplomacy.

Editorial Calendar

The editorial calendar [Figure 4] provides an outline for what kind of tasks should be completed when, by whom, for whom, and for what reason. The content shown would be the first steps in implementing the overall content plan as described thus far in the report.

Figure 4: Content Calendar

Content Type	Task Description	Frequency	Assigned Roles	Target Audience	Goals
Blog Post- for the “Internships” webpage	Write a blog post titled: “How to Search for Internships.” Interview subject matter experts (professors, industry leaders) and include examples.	A one-time activity that should be reviewed and updated yearly.	Social Media Manager or a Professor	Current UNT Tech Comm Students	To give students information on how to accurately conduct an internship search—including what titles to look for, which sites to use, and when to apply.
Blog Post- for the “Internships” webpage	Write a blog post titled: “How to Apply for Internships.” Interview professors, executives, or HR personnel and include examples of good applications.	A one-time activity that should be reviewed and updated yearly.	Social Media Manager or a Professor	Current UNT Tech Comm Students	Post would provide students with insight on applying for internships: what qualifications they should have, how their resume should look, what to include in the resume, how to prepare for an interview, etc.
Faculty and Staff Pages	Update pages so that each profile contains the same type of information. Also update all profile pictures, bios, and add office hours to all accounts.	Update every 4-6 months.	Administrative Specialist	Current UNT Tech Comm Students, faculty members and staff	Provides students, faculty, and staff members with consistent information across the faculty and staff pages. Updating the profile photos would also provide a more UNT-aligned and professional look.

Alumni Pages	Update alumni testimonials to include recent graduates. Find and interview Tech Comm alumni, request profile photos, write testimonial, and post.	Update Yearly	Administrative Specialist	Current UNT Tech Comm Students	Would provide students with current “success stories” to look up to. Would also give the UNT Tech Comm pages a more updated “look” since currently the most recent Alumni testimony is from 2016, and the pictures appear outdated.
LinkedIn Post	A post titled “What to Include in Your Resume.” Consult subject matter experts, professors, even UNT alumni. Write up their tips for good resume writing. Provide a template or two as well.	Review yearly.	Social Media Manager or a Professor	Current and Future UNT Tech Comm Students	It would help current UNT students (and even some Alumni) to update their resumes in an efficient way in order to get the job or internship they want.